9.11 Rheumatoid Arthritis*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "My hand joints are swollen and stiff for hours in the morning." **Objective** • Symmetrical joint swelling • Raised ESR • Morning stiffness over 1 hour	**ACTUAL** Chronic pain related to joint inflammation as evidenced by swollen, painful joints.	• Less pain and stiffness.	• Give DMARDs and anti-inflammatory drugs as prescribed. • Suggest a warm shower in the morning. • Balance rest with exercise.	• Outcome reached as pain eases.
Subjective • "I cannot button my shirt." **Objective** • Hand deformity • Takes 30 minutes to dress	**ACTUAL** Decreased dressing abilities related to joint deformity as evidenced by inability to fasten buttons.	• Dresses unaided using adaptive aids.	• Refer to occupational therapy. • Suggest Velcro fastenings and adapted clothing.	• Considered met when dressing independently.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Immunosuppressive therapy • Low white cell count	**RISK** Risk for infection as evidenced by risk factors: immunosuppressive therapy.	• No infection.	• Follow blood counts as ordered. • Ask her to report fever. • Check her vaccination status.	• Goal reached if no infection develops.

* **References for this care plan:** [32], [35], [37], [83]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.